QUEENS PEACE PALACE

# THE ABANDONMENT RECLAMATION

A Guided Reflection for Understanding the Fear,
Rebuilding Safety & Staying With Yourself

**NOTICE.** REASSURE. REMAIN.

TO THY OWN SELF BE TRUE

*The Inner Work Collection*

# Before You Begin

Fear of abandonment can shape the way we attach, trust, ask for reassurance, respond to distance, and interpret changes in relationships. It may be connected to childhood loss, emotional neglect, inconsistency, rejection, or later experiences that taught you closeness could disappear without warning.

The original Queens Peace Palace worksheet explored people-pleasing, overgiving, distrust, pushing people away, insecurity, reassurance-seeking, control, relationship sabotage and lack of emotional intimacy. This edition keeps those themes while asking a deeper question: *what do you do when the fear of being left becomes louder than what is actually happening?*

> **This work is not about convincing yourself that nobody will ever leave.**
> It is about building enough inner safety that another person's presence or absence does not require you to abandon yourself.

### A note on support

This workbook is for personal reflection and education. It is not therapy, diagnosis, or crisis care. Abandonment and emotional-neglect experiences can be painful to revisit; if the material becomes overwhelming, consider pausing and working with a licensed mental-health professional or another qualified source of support.

### YOUR INTENTION

*What would feeling safer in love, friendship and connection look like for you?*

# What happens when you fear someone may leave?

Abandonment fear does not always look like clinging. Sometimes it looks like leaving first, shutting down, overgiving, controlling, testing, or pretending you do not care.

*When I feel uncertain about someone's connection to me, I tend to...*

- ■ Seek repeated reassurance
- ■ People-please or overgive
- ■ Monitor changes in tone, texting, affection or availability
- ■ Assume distance means rejection
- ■ Push the person away before they can leave
- ■ Become controlling or demanding
- ■ Shut down or detach
- ■ Move quickly toward another connection
- ■ Ignore my own needs to preserve the relationship
- ■ Sabotage the connection
- ■ Other: _____

*Which of these patterns has cost you the most?*

# When did leaving begin to feel dangerous?

Your original worksheet invited reflection on childhood at different ages, feeling unloved, invisible or powerless, and what you needed most. This page keeps that inner-child doorway while giving it more structure.

*My childhood felt like...*

*At age 5, I remember needing...*

*At age 10, I remember needing...*

*At age 15, I remember needing...*

*The first time I remember feeling emotionally left, invisible, rejected or powerless was...*

# What did the experience teach you to believe?

Painful experiences often create conclusions that continue long after the original moment: *people always leave, I am too much, I am not enough, I have to earn love, I cannot relax, I need to stay useful, I should leave first.*

*The story I learned about love or closeness was...*

*The story I learned about myself was...*

*The rule I started following to avoid being abandoned was...*

**Palace Reflection**
A survival rule can keep operating long after the environment that created it has changed.

# What is happening - and what are you afraid is happening?

When abandonment fear is activated, uncertainty can quickly become a conclusion. This practice helps separate observable information from the story your fear is building around it.

### THE FACTS I ACTUALLY HAVE

### THE STORY MY FEAR IS TELLING ME

### WHAT I DO NOT KNOW YET

*What could I ask, clarify or observe before deciding what this means?*

# What do you abandon when you are afraid of being abandoned?

Sometimes the deepest cost of abandonment fear is not only what another person may do. It is how quickly we may leave our own needs, boundaries, intuition, routines, dignity or truth in order to keep connection.

*When I am afraid someone will leave, I abandon my...*

- ■ Needs
- ■ Boundaries
- ■ Standards
- ■ Voice
- ■ Intuition
- ■ Time
- ■ Other relationships
- ■ Routines
- ■ Self-respect
- ■ Desires
- ■ Rest
- ■ Other: _____

*What have you tolerated, overgiven, hidden or silenced to keep someone close?*

*What would staying loyal to yourself look like in the same situation?*

# It is okay to need reassurance. What matters is what you do with the need.

Wanting comfort, consistency and reassurance does not make you weak. The goal is to notice when reassurance becomes the only thing capable of settling you - or when you repeatedly trade your own judgment for someone else's temporary words.

*When I ask for reassurance, what am I really hoping to hear?*

*What reassurance can another person reasonably give me?*

*What reassurance can only be built through my own actions and self-trust?*

**Try this distinction:**
“Can you reassure me?” and “Can you prove I will never be hurt?” are not the same request.

# Closeness does not require constant contact.

Abandonment fear can make ordinary separateness feel threatening. Healthy connection has room for two whole people: different schedules, friendships, interests, moods and periods of space without automatically turning that space into rejection.

*What kinds of distance trigger you most?*

- ■ Delayed replies
- ■ Changed tone
- ■ Plans changing
- ■ A partner/friend spending time elsewhere
- ■ Less affection than usual
- ■ Conflict
- ■ Someone asking for space
- ■ Physical distance
- ■ Not knowing what someone is doing
- ■ Other: _____

*What meaning do you usually assign to that distance?*

*What is a more balanced interpretation that does NOT require you to ignore real patterns?*

*What would secure space look like to you?*

# Give younger you what they could not give themselves.

Your original worksheet affirmed that your feelings matter, your needs matter, you deserve care, and you did not choose emotional neglect. This page turns those truths into a direct conversation with the younger parts of you.

*What did you need most as a child that you did not consistently receive?*

*What would you want younger you to know now about why people failed to meet that need?*

*Write to younger you: "When you are afraid everyone will leave, I want you to remember…"*

**Reparenting is not pretending the past did not matter.**
It is refusing to make younger you continue facing the same fear alone.

# Build safety without making promises life cannot make.

The original worksheet used affirmations around needs, care, asking for help, feelings, lovability and self-validation. These statements keep that foundation while centering self-trust.

*“My needs do not make me difficult to love.”*

*“I can ask for reassurance without abandoning my own judgment.”*

*“I do not have to overgive to earn consistency.”*

*“Someone needing space does not automatically mean I am being rejected.”*

*“If a connection changes, I will still remain with myself.”*

*“I can survive disappointment without turning it into proof that I am unlovable.”*

*Write three statements for YOUR abandonment story.*

**1.**

**2.**

**3.**

# What would you do if fear were not making the decision?

Healing abandonment patterns does not mean becoming detached or never needing anyone. It means creating relationships where connection and self-respect are allowed to exist together.

*One behavior I want to stop using to prevent abandonment is...*

*One need I want to communicate more directly is...*

*One boundary I need in order to feel more secure is...*

*One way I can stay connected to myself when someone else feels distant is...*

*One relationship pattern I want to choose differently moving forward is...*

**THE PALACE CHECK-IN**

Do not ask only, “Did they stay?” Ask: “Did I stay with myself? Did I tell the truth? Did I honor my needs? Did I let their behavior give me information instead of making it a verdict on my worth?”

RETURN TO YOURSELF

# The deepest promise is not that nobody will ever leave.

***It is that you will not leave yourself to keep them.***

You are allowed to love deeply, need people, ask for reassurance, grieve endings and still build a center that belongs to you. Safety is not certainty. It is knowing that whatever changes around you, you have a relationship with yourself to return to.

**Remember:**
Connection is not supposed to cost you your own presence.

## Need support going deeper?

If this reflection uncovered something you would like support navigating, Queens Peace Palace offers private Spiritual Life Coaching for clarity, self-trust, relationships, transitions and personal growth.

**queenspeacepalace.com**

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